RESTAURANTS

HAUTE TABLES

MAKEOVERS ARE GIVING MUMBAI'S **LEGACY RESTAURANTS** *A FRESH LEASE OF LIFE*

On Mumbai's culinary landscape, it's common to see new restaurants mushrooming almost daily, only to die off as quickly. Surprisingly, in this gone-in-60-seconds culture, there are many iconic restaurants that survive. Here are a few that have reinvented and revitalised in recent times....

PRITAM DA DHABA

● **Then:** The Kohlis from Rawalpindi took over the Pritam Hindu Hotel which was functioning since 1942 and rechristened it as they brought the food of the Punjab to newly formed India in 1947. It's universally hailed as the birthplace of butter chicken in Mumbai.

● **Now:** While they've added new items over the years, the latest avatar of this iconic eatery headed by fourth-generation restaurateur Jaibir Kohli sees a (logical) expansion into Juhu and décor that blends a rustic dhaba vibe with contemporary style and Instagrammable truck-art wall murals. Bollywood Retro Cocktails elevate it from its Patiala-peg positioning.

GAYLORD

● **Then:** Friends Pishori Lal Lamba and Iqbal Krishan Ghai, who sold ice-cream and later opened the Kwality Restaurant in Delhi's Connaught Place in 1947 decided to create a new brand in Mumbai. That's how Gaylord was born in 1956.

● **Now:** Seeing the slew of swanky establishments reviving the street where Gaylord held sway for so long, owner Sunil Lamba and his sons Dhruv and Divij, decided to upgrade it. The refurbish involves glamorous red, black, and white interiors. The walls are lined with over a hundred gilt-framed black & white photographs. While the décor and the old team take you back into a colourful past, a super glam bar and signature cocktails fast forward you into the future.

COPPER CHIMNEY

● **Then:** Copper Chimney was started by J.K. Kapur—who migrated from Lahore during Partition—in Worli in 1972, and helmed by Chef Tari, a woman, which was a rarity then. The show kitchen was the first one in India.

● **Now:** Boasting pan-Indian and international footprints, the brand has been



PAST MEETS THE FUTURE
Clockwise from top: Jaibir Kohli, director, Pritam Group of Hotels; Kebab Korner; the show kitchen at Copper Chimney, the 'Pran' drink from Pritam Da Dhaba; and the beautiful bar at the iconic Gaylord restaurant